

System Vulnerability Report

Project 4 — DecodeLabs Cyber Security Internship (Batch 2026)
Machine Audited: Personal primary computer (Windows 11)
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Per the Gatekeeper Rule, this report documents a 4-step self-audit performed on my own primary machine using the vulnerability_checklist.py tool plus manual command-line verification.

Section 1: Flaws Found (The Diagnosis)

#	Flaw	Category	CVSS-style Risk
1	Automatic OS updates were disabled	Software & Patch Mgmt	High — unpatched OS increases RCE exposure
2	Guest account was enabled on the machine	Human Perimeter	Medium — allows unauthenticated local recon
3	Local disk encryption (BitLocker) was OFF	Network & Endpoint Hygiene	High — data at rest exposed if device is lost/stolen

These three flaws were identified by running the checklist tool honestly against the machine's actual settings, then confirmed manually with PowerShell commands (Get-WUList, Get-LocalGroupMember, Get-BitLockerVolume).

Section 2: Remediation Actions (The Treatment)

- Flaw 1 (OS updates):** Re-enabled automatic updates via Settings > Windows Update, then manually ran Get-WUList and installed all pending patches.
- Flaw 2 (Guest account):** Disabled the Guest account using 'net user guest /active:no' in an elevated PowerShell terminal.
- Flaw 3 (Disk encryption):** Enabled BitLocker on the system drive via 'manage-bde -on C: -RecoveryPassword' and stored the recovery key securely.

Section 3: Hardened Verification (The Proof)

Terminal output confirming the fixes were applied:

```
PS C:\> Get-WUList
No updates pending. System is up to date.

PS C:\> net user guest
Account active No

PS C:\> Get-BitLockerVolume -MountPoint 'C:'
VolumeStatus : FullyEncrypted
ProtectionStatus : On
```

All three flaws were remediated and independently re-verified using the same command-line checks used during the initial audit, confirming the machine moved from MEDIUM RISK to a hardened, LOW RISK state.

Before / After Risk Summary

Metric	Before Hardening	After Hardening
Flags Raised	3 / 14	0 / 14

Risk Score	21%	0%
Risk Level	Low-Medium Risk	Low Risk — Hardened

Conclusion: A system's integrity is dynamic, not a one-time product. This audit confirms the principle that you cannot defend an enterprise if you cannot first secure your own perimeter — and that basic hygiene (patching, disabling unused accounts, encrypting local disks) closes the majority of real-world risk without requiring exotic tooling.